

FEMA RAG Assessment Outputs

Run all 15 required questions with retrieval metadata

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Submission Summary

Top-k retrieval: 5
Conversation mode: single-conversation
Started: 3/20/2026, 11:42:46 AM
Completed: 3/20/2026, 11:43:55 AM
Each question begins on a new page.

What is the Cost Estimating Format (CEF) and what types of projects is it used for?

The Cost Estimating Format (CEF) is a cost estimating methodology used by FEMA cost estimators and construction engineers to estimate total costs for large projects. It is a forward pricing model based on construction industry standards that accounts for all possible costs associated with a project. The CEF provides better up-front estimates, helps budget project costs with greater confidence, and offers information to manage projects effectively. The CEF is applied in parts, with Part A representing the base cost of completing the project (labor, materials, equipment), and Parts B through H including job-specific factors added to the base cost (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages, Pages: 56).

The CEF is used specifically for large projects where the permanent restorative work (categories C, D, E, F, and G) is less than 90 percent complete. The percent complete is calculated by dividing the amount of approved contractor invoices for eligible work by the approved construction contract amount for eligible work and multiplying by 100 (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: <http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large Project, Pages: 1).

In summary:

- CEF is a detailed cost estimating tool for large projects.
- It estimates total project costs using a structured format with base costs and additional factors.
- It is used only for large projects with less than 90% completion of permanent restorative work (categories C-G).

(Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • The CEF Information Update (January 1999) provides an overview of FEMA's cost; <http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large Project; Pages: 1; fema323_app_handbk.pdf; Section: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages, Pages: 56)

Question 1 (continued)

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.860

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.877

CEF_SOP

p.1

&ó Procedure > • The CEF Information Update (January 1999) provides an overview of FEMA
§ • The CEF Information Update (January 1999) provides an overview of FEMA's cost

[Procedure / step context: • The CEF Information Update (January 1999) provides an overview of FEMA's cost]

Cost Estimating Format (CEF)

For Large Projects

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

SOP9570.8

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #0 · cef_sop.pdf

#2 0.857

ApplicantHandb

p.56

§ Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages

[Section path: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages]

large project will be adjusted after all work is complete.

FEMA cost estimators and construction engineers use a cost

estimating methodology called the Cost Estimated Format (CEF)

to estimate your total costs for each project. The CEF is a forward

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #126 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

Question 1 (continued)

#3 0.856

CEF_SOP

p.1

&6 Procedure > | Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) SOP9570.8 |

[Procedure / step context: | Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) SOP9570.8 |

| Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) SOP9570.8 |

| --- |

| • Electrical • Plumbing • Repair and Remodeling • Square Foot Costs • Site Work and Landscape • If the Project Specialist uses national industry standard ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #34 · cef_sop.pdf

#4 0.855

CEF_SOP

p.2

&6 Procedure > estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if applicable), and local costs for plan checks, building permits, or special reviews. The PA Group Supervisor will collect and evaluate this information for use in all CEF analyses at the beginning of each disaster. • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (Part A of the CEF); including Special Considerations and appropriate Section 406 hazard mitigation for large projects that meet the CEF criteria. Projects Specialists will ...

[Procedure / step context: estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if applicable), and local costs for plan checks, building permits, or special reviews. The PA Group Supervisor will collect and evaluate this information for use in all CEF analyses at the beginning of each disaster. • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (Part A of the CEF); including Special Considerations and appropriate Section 406 hazard mitigation for large projects that meet the CEF criteria. Projects Specialists will ...

estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if applicable), and local costs for plan checks, building permits, or special reviews. The PA Group Supervisor will collect and evaluate this information for use in all CEF analyses at the beginning of each disaster. • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (Part A of the CEF); including Special Considerations and appropriate Section 406 hazard mitigation for large projects that meet the CEF criteria. Projects Specialists will ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #12 · cef_sop.pdf

Question 1 (continued)

#5 0.855

CEF_SOP

p.1

&ó Procedure > <http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large
§ <http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large Project

[Procedure / step context:

<http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large
Project]

<http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large
Projects can the CEF be used to estimate costs? The CEF should only be used on
large projects for which the permanent restorative work (categories C, D, E, F,
and G) is less than 90 percent complete. Percent complete for all types of
projects (including improved and alternate projects) is calculated by dividing
the amount of approved contractor invoices for eligible work by the approved

...

Who determines which local factors to use when developing a CEF cost estimate, and what factors do they consider?

The Public Assistance (PA) Group Supervisor or designee determines which local factors to use when developing a CEF cost estimate. They consider factors such as unit price sources, city cost indices (if applicable), and local costs for plan checks, building permits, or special reviews. The PA Group Supervisor collects and evaluates this information for use in all CEF analyses at the beginning of each disaster and identifies the zip codes included in the declared area to research appropriate city cost factors for use by Project Specialists (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Sections: • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, t; estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if app), | Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (, Pages: 1-2).

Sources (retrieved):

- (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A; t, Page: 2)
- (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: | Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (, Page: 1)
- (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources; city cost indices (if app, Page: 2)
- (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages, Page: 56)
- (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: <http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large Project, Page: 1)

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.856

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

Question 2 (continued)

#1 0.865

CEF_SOP

p.2

&ó Procedure > • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, t
§ • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, t

[Procedure / step context: • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, t]

• After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, the Project

Specialist will complete Parts B through H (the factors applied to the base cost) of the

CEF. The Project Specialist will develop separate summaries for completed and ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #11 · cef_sop.pdf

#2 0.864

CEF_SOP

p.1

&ó Procedure > | Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) SOP9570.8 |
§ | Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (

[Procedure / step context: | Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (]

| Cost Estimating Format (CEF) For Large Projects Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) SOP9570.8 |

| --- |

| • Electrical • Plumbing • Repair and Remodeling • Square Foot Costs • Site Work and Landscape • If the Project Specialist uses national industry standard ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #34 · cef_sop.pdf

Question 2 (continued)

#3 0.859

CEF_SOP p.2

&ô Procedure > estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if
§ estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if app

[Procedure / step context: estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if app]

estimate. Specific factors include unit price sources, city cost indices (if applicable), and local costs for plan checks, building permits, or special reviews. The PA Group Supervisor will collect and evaluate this information for use in all CEF analyses at the beginning of each disaster. • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (Part A of the CEF); including Special Considerations and appropriate Section 406 hazard mitigation for large projects that meet the CEF criteria. Projects Specialists will

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #12 · cef_sop.pdf

#4 0.848

ApplicantHandb p.56

§ Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages

[Section path: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages]

large project will be adjusted after all work is complete.

FEMA cost estimators and construction engineers use a cost

estimating methodology called the Cost Estimated Format (CEF)

to estimate your total costs for each project. The CEF is a forward

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #126 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

Question 2 (continued)

#5 0.842

CEF_SOP

p.1

&ó Procedure > <http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large
§ <http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large Project

[Procedure / step context:

<http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large
Project]

<http://www.fema.gov/government/grant/pa/resources.shtm>). For which Large
Projects can the CEF be used to estimate costs? The CEF should only be used on
large projects for which the permanent restorative work (categories C, D, E, F,
and G) is less than 90 percent complete. Percent complete for all types of
projects (including improved and alternate projects) is calculated by dividing
the amount of approved contractor invoices for eligible work by the approved

...

What is Strategic Funds Management (SFM) and what is its purpose?

Strategic Funds Management (SFM) is FEMA's process for obligating Public Assistance project funding based on a subgrantee's schedule to execute the eligible work. Its purpose is to ensure that FEMA obligates funds for eligible subgrantee projects in alignment with the project schedule. This process enhances the national management and use of Disaster Relief Fund (DRF) resources consistent with appropriations and the Budget Control Act, and helps avoid project funding restrictions that may arise (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Sections: 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for the Public Assistance Program, Pages: 1-2).

Sources (retrieved):

- (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Section: | 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for the Publ, Page: 1)
- (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Section: SOP 9570.24, Page: 1)
- (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: 429 For more information; refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24)., Page: 237)
- (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Section: 2.2 Enter the project cost estimate in the Project Cost section of the PW using, Page: 2)
- (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Section: 4.1 Upon PW obligation; the standard Grants Management and Program Management re, Page: 4)

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.776

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

Question 3 (continued)

#1 0.809

SFM_SOP

p.1

&ó Procedure > | 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for
§ | 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for the Publ

[Procedure / step context: | 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management –
Implementation Procedures for the Publ]

| 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for the
Public Assistance Program 2.0 Date: December 21, 2012 3.0 Purpose: The purpose
of this Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) is to establish the process for
implementing Strategic Funds Management (SFM) in the Public Assistance Program.
Strategic Funds Management is FEMA’s process for obligating Public Assistance
project funding based on a subgrantee’s schedule to execute the eligible work.
The SFM initiative ensures that FEMA obligates funds for eligible subgrantee

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #3 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

#2 0.806

SFM_SOP

p.1

&ó Procedure > SOP 9570.24
§ SOP 9570.24

[Procedure / step context: SOP 9570.24]

SOP 9570.24

RECOVERY STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures
for the Public Assistance Program

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #0 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Question 3 (continued)

#3 0.797

PAPPG

p.237

§ 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).

[Section path: 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).]

[Section: 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).]

430 44 C.F.R. § 206.200(b)(2)(i).

431 44 C.F.R. § 206.202(a).

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #1105 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#4 0.735

SFM_SOP

p.2

&6 Procedure > 2.2 Enter the project cost estimate in the Project Cost section of the PW
§ 2.2 Enter the project cost estimate in the Project Cost section of the PW using

[Procedure / step context: 2.2 Enter the project cost estimate in the Project Cost section of the PW using]

2.2 Enter the project cost estimate in the Project Cost section of the PW using cost code 9930 Pending Strategic Fund Management (SFM). 1 SFM does not apply to any judgments awarded in litigation or arbitration, which may immediately create financial liabilities resulting in an obligation for the full amount of the judgment or award. |

| Page 2 of 6 |

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #12 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Question 3 (continued)

#5 0.734

SFM SOP

p.4

&ô Procedure > 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Ma
§ 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management re

[Procedure / step context: 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management re]

4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management requirements as outlined in the Program Management and Closure SOP apply to the project. 4.2 Additional PW versions will proceed pursuant to the normal course of project implementation and funding. Step 5: Reporting 5.1 Reports on SFM projects can be generated from EMMIE/EDW (Enterprise Data Warehouse). 5.2 FEMA Regions are encouraged to share SFM reports with grantees for ongoing coordination on implementation of SFM projects. 5.3 As part of LPN tracking and ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #22 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

What types of entities are eligible to apply for FEMA Public Assistance?

The types of entities eligible to apply for FEMA Public Assistance are:

- State, local, Tribal Nation, and territorial (SLTT) entities
- Private nonprofit (PNP) organizations, including houses of worship and other faith-based organizations

(Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: I. Applicant Eligibility, Pages: 49) (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: Public Assistance, Pages: 1)

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.849

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.878

ApplicantHandb p.1

§ Public Assistance

[Section path: Public Assistance]

Public Assistance

Applicant Handbook

FEMA P-323 / March 2010

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #0 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

Question 4 (continued)

#2 0.855

PAPPG

p.49

&ô Chapter 3: Applying for Public Assistance and > I. Applicant Eligibility
§ I. Applicant Eligibility

[Section path: Chapter 3: Applying for Public Assistance and > I. Applicant Eligibility]

[Section: I. Applicant Eligibility]

FEMA provides assistance to eligible applicants, which are defined below. As shown in Figure 3. Applicant

Eligibility, FEMA must first determine whether an applicant is eligible before evaluating the applicant's claim.

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #213 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#3 0.847

ApplicantHandb p.3

§ Foreword

[Section path: Foreword]

applicants can obtain help through the Public Assistance Program. Potential recipients of this assistance include State, Tribal, and local governments and certain types of private nonprofit organizations.

The mission of the Public Assistance Program is to assist communities in

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #2 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

Question 4 (continued)

#4 0.834

PAPPG

p.105

&6 209 For more information, refer to: Cooperative Purchasing Programs | fema.gov. > Terminology

[Section path: 209 For more information, refer to: Cooperative Purchasing Programs | fema.gov. > Terminology]

[Section: Terminology]

Requesting entity - An entity that requests mutual aid assistance from an assisting entity for work

resulting from a declared fire, emergency, or major disaster within its legal jurisdiction.

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #478 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#5 0.832

PAPPG

p.38

&6 37 Stafford Act § 102(2); 42 U.S.C. § 5122; 44 C.F.R. § 206.2(a)(17). > D. Types of Assistance

[Section path: 37 Stafford Act § 102(2); 42 U.S.C. § 5122; 44 C.F.R. § 206.2(a)(17). > D. Types of Assistance]

[Section: D. Types of Assistance]

The declaration designates the types of federal assistance authorized.⁴² The types of assistance authorized

differs between emergency and major disaster declarations and may vary among declared areas. For

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #164 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

What are the two main types of federal disaster declarations, and what assistance is available under each?

The two main types of federal disaster declarations are:

- **Emergency Declarations**: These authorize limited immediate and short-term assistance essential to save lives, protect property and public health and safety, or to lessen or avert the threat of catastrophe. The president may authorize supplemental emergency assistance under this declaration type (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: Closeout, Pages: 116) (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: D. Types of Assistance, Pages: 38).
- **Major Disaster Declarations**: These authorize a broader range of assistance including Individual Assistance (IA), Hazard Mitigation Programs, and Public Assistance (PA). IA provides assistance to eligible individuals and households, while PA supports state, local, tribal, territorial entities, and certain nonprofits (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: A. Incident Type; D. Types of Assistance; Pages: 37-38). The declaration also establishes the type of incident; incident period; designated areas; types of assistance; federal cost share; and Federal Coordinating Officer (FCO) (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf; Section: IV. Declaration Determinations, Pages: 37).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.855

3 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

Question 5 (continued)

#1 0.885

ApplicantHandb p.116

§ Closeout

[Section path: Closeout]

contingency factors, applied as a percentage of the base cost.

Declarations

There are two types of declarations (Emergency Declarations and Major Disaster Declarations). Both declaration types authorize the President to

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #226 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

#2 0.864

PAPPG p.37

&6 32 For more information, refer to: Tribal Declarations Interim Guidance | fema.gov. > /
§ A. Incident Type

[Section path: 32 For more information, refer to: Tribal Declarations Interim Guidance | fema.gov. > A. Incident Type]

[Section: A. Incident Type]

The declaration designates the type of incident (e.g., hurricane, wildfire, or earthquake). For emergency

declarations, an incident is any instance determined by the president that warrants supplemental

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #160 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 5 (continued)

#3 0.846

PAPPG

p.37

&6 32 For more information, refer to: Tribal Declarations Interim Guidance | fema.gov. > IV. Declaration Determinations

[Section path: 32 For more information, refer to: Tribal Declarations Interim Guidance | fema.gov. > IV. Declaration Determinations]

[Section: IV. Declaration Determinations]

For FEMA to provide assistance, the president must declare that an emergency or major disaster exists.³⁵

The declaration establishes the:

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #159 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#4 0.843

PAPPG

p.38

&6 37 Stafford Act § 102(2); 42 U.S.C. § 5122; 44 C.F.R. § 206.2(a)(17). > D. Types of Assistance
§ D. Types of Assistance

[Section path: 37 Stafford Act § 102(2); 42 U.S.C. § 5122; 44 C.F.R. § 206.2(a)(17). > D. Types of Assistance]

[Section: D. Types of Assistance]

The declaration designates the types of federal assistance authorized.⁴² The types of assistance authorized

differs between emergency and major disaster declarations and may vary among declared areas. For

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #164 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 5 (continued)

#5 0.836

DamageAssessme p. 9

\$ Familiarity with the FEMA Recovery information that is used to evaluate

[Section path: Familiarity with the FEMA Recovery information that is used to evaluate]

Programs Individual Assistance (IA) and requests for a Major Disaster

Public Assistance (PA) can be helpful in

Declaration.

Strategy: SectionChunker · Chunk #31 · FEMADAOM.pdf

In the CEF process, what is the difference between Part A and Part B of the cost estimate, and who is responsible for each?

- **Part A** of the CEF represents the base cost of completing the project. It includes the labor, materials, and equipment necessary to complete each item of the eligible scope of work. The Project Specialist prepares Part A by estimating costs for both completed and uncompleted work, separating eligible from ineligible work, and reconciling actual costs against prior estimates if available (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A; t, Pages: 2) (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages, Pages: 56).

- **Parts B through H** contain job-specific factors that are applied to the base cost determined in Part A. These factors adjust the base cost to reflect project-specific conditions. The Project Specialist is responsible for completing Parts B through H for both completed and uncompleted work (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A; t, Pages: 2) (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages, Pages: 56).

- The **Project Specialist** is responsible for preparing Part A and completing Parts B through H of the CEF estimate (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A; t, Pages: 2).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.870

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

Question 6 (continued)

#1 0.888

CEF_SOP

p.2

&ó Procedure > • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, t
§ • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, t

[Procedure / step context: • After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, t]

• After the eligible scope of work and its base costs are completed in Part A, the Project

Specialist will complete Parts B through H (the factors applied to the base cost) of the

CEF. The Project Specialist will develop separate summaries for completed and ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #11 · cef_sop.pdf

#2 0.869

CEF_SOP

p.6

&ó Procedure > writing. How is completed work costs included when the CEF is used for e
§ writing. How is completed work costs included when the CEF is used for estimatin

[Procedure / step context: writing. How is completed work costs included when the CEF is used for estimatin]

writing. How is completed work costs included when the CEF is used for estimating the total cost of a Large Project that is less than 90 percent complete? The Project Specialist will prepare a Part A estimate using the CEF for Large Projects spreadsheet for the entire project. The Project Specialist is responsible for separating eligible work from ineligible work. If the applicant had an estimate prepared before the work was completed, the Project Specialist should compare the actual costs against that estimate, and if reasonable,

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #43 · cef_sop.pdf

Question 6 (continued)

#3 0.868

CEF_SOP p.6

&ó Procedure > costs against it, and if reasonable, reconcile the cost differences. The re
§ costs against it, and if reasonable, reconcile the cost differences. The result

[Procedure / step context: costs against it, and if reasonable, reconcile the cost differences. The result]

costs against it, and if reasonable, reconcile the cost differences. The result should be entered in Part A "Summary for Completed Work." In both instances, the Project Specialist will also prepare a Part A CEF estimate for the uncompleted work portion using either average weighted unit prices or industry standard construction cost estimating resources (e.g. RSMeans, BNi Costbooks, Marshall & Swift, Sweet's Unit Cost Guide, etc.). The Project Specialist is also responsible for completing Parts B through H, as appropriate, for both the ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #44 · cef_sop.pdf

#4 0.866

ApplicantHandb p.56

§ Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages

[Section path: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages]

large project will be adjusted after all work is complete.

FEMA cost estimators and construction engineers use a cost

estimating methodology called the Cost Estimated Format (CEF)

to estimate your total costs for each project. The CEF is a forward

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #126 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

#5 0.858 CEF_SOP p.3

&ó Procedure > |---|
\$ |---|

[Procedure / step context: |---|]

|---|

| • The Project Specialist will complete the Project Cost section of the PW as follows: ð\$ Item - Enter sequential item number statement "See attached CEF spreadsheet for itemized unit-price estimate particulars" ð\$ Quantity/Unit - 1 LS (lump sum estimate value from the CEF spreadsheet ð\$ App the CEF line-item #1 (e.g., a deduction for anticipated or actual insurance
...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #20 · cef_sop.pdf

When does the SFM SOP NOT apply? What exceptions exist?

The Strategic Funds Management (SFM) SOP does NOT apply to judgments awarded in litigation or arbitration, which may immediately create financial liabilities resulting in an obligation for the full amount of the judgment or award (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Section: Step 2: Eligibility Determination for Scope of Work, Pages: 2).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.818

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.834

& Procedure > SOP 9570.24
§ SOP 9570.24

[Procedure / step context: SOP 9570.24]

SOP 9570.24

RECOVERY STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures
for the Public Assistance Program

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #0 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

SFM_SOP

p.1

Question 7 (continued)

#2 0.826

PAPPG

p.237

§ 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).

[Section path: 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).]

[Section: 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).]

430 44 C.F.R. § 206.200(b)(2)(i).

431 44 C.F.R. § 206.202(a).

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #1105 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#3 0.814

SFM_SOP

p.2

&6 Procedure > Step 2: Eligibility Determination for Scope of Work

§ Step 2: Eligibility Determination for Scope of Work

[Procedure / step context: Step 2: Eligibility Determination for Scope of Work]

Step 2: Eligibility Determination for Scope of Work

2.1 Document the eligible SOW and the associated cost estimate for the project.

2.2 Enter the project cost estimate in the Project Cost section of the PW using

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #8 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Question 7 (continued)

#4 0.810

SFM_SOP

p.1

&6 Procedure > | 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for
§ | 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for the Publ

[Procedure / step context: | 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management –
Implementation Procedures for the Publ]

| 1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures for the
Public Assistance Program 2.0 Date: December 21, 2012 3.0 Purpose: The purpose
of this Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) is to establish the process for
implementing Strategic Funds Management (SFM) in the Public Assistance Program.
Strategic Funds Management is FEMA's process for obligating Public Assistance
project funding based on a subgrantee's schedule to execute the eligible work.
The SFM initiative ensures that FEMA obligates funds for eligible subgrantee

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #3 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

#5 0.806

SFM_SOP

p.4

&6 Procedure > 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Ma
§ 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management re

[Procedure / step context: 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants
Management and Program Management re]

4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management
requirements as outlined in the Program Management and Closure SOP apply to the
project. 4.2 Additional PW versions will proceed pursuant to the normal course
of project implementation and funding. Step 5: Reporting 5.1 Reports on SFM
projects can be generated from EMMIE/EDW (Enterprise Data Warehouse). 5.2 FEMA
Regions are encouraged to share SFM reports with grantees for ongoing
coordination on implementation of SFM projects. 5.3 As part of LPN tracking and

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #22 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Explain the process for a subgrantee to receive PA funding, from the initial Request for Public Assistance through final obligation. Reference the relevant SOPs and guides.

The process for a subgrantee to receive Public Assistance (PA) funding involves several key steps from the initial Request for Public Assistance (RPA) through final obligation:

1. **Request for Public Assistance (RPA):**

The subgrantee, which can be a State agency, local government, Indian Tribe, authorized tribal organization, Alaska Native village or organization, or certain private nonprofit organizations, initiates the process by submitting an RPA following a presidential disaster declaration (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: Applicant Eligibility, Pages: 49).

2. **Eligibility Determination:**

FEMA and the State work together to determine the eligibility of the applicant and the damages or work eligible for PA funding. The State Public Assistance Representative acts as the applicant's point of contact to assist in obtaining FEMA assistance (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: Small Project, Pages: 121).

3. **State Administrative Plan:**

Before FEMA provides PA funding, the State must have an approved State Administrative Plan that outlines how it will administer the PA Program, including staffing and responsibilities. This plan must be on file with FEMA before grants are approved (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: Small Project, Pages: 121) (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: K. Public Assistance Administrative Plan, Pages: 41).

4. **Applicant Briefings and Technical Assistance:**

The State and FEMA conduct applicant briefings to inform subgrantees about the PA Program, eligibility, and application procedures. Technical assistance is provided to help applicants prepare documentation and understand program requirements (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: K. Public Assistance Administrative Plan, Pages: 41).

5. **Project Formulation and Cost Estimation:**

Subgrantees work with FEMA to identify eligible work and develop project worksheets that estimate the cost of eligible repairs or replacement. This includes separating eligible from ineligible work and reconciling costs (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Foreword, Page: 3).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.850

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.862

ApplicantHandb p.3

§ Foreword

[Section path: Foreword]

applicants can obtain help through the Public Assistance Program. Potential recipients of this assistance include State, Tribal, and local governments and certain types of private nonprofit organizations.

The mission of the Public Assistance Program is to assist communities in

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #2 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

#2 0.849

PAPPG p.41

¶ 54 For more information, refer to: FEMA New Recipients of Disaster Grants Guide. > K. Public Assistance Administrative Plan

[Section path: 54 For more information, refer to: FEMA New Recipients of Disaster Grants Guide. > K. Public Assistance Administrative Plan]

[Section: K. Public Assistance Administrative Plan]

Recipients must have a FEMA-approved administrative plan⁵⁸ that describes how it intends to administer the

PA Program before FEMA provides PA funding for any project. At a minimum, the administrative plan must

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #180 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 8 (continued)

#3 0.849

PAPPG

p.29

&6 Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
and Use

§ I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use

[Section path: Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout

..... 253 > I.
Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

[Section: I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

The Federal Emergency Management Agency's (FEMA's) "Public Assistance Program Policy Guide" (PAPPG)

contains consolidated Public Assistance (PA) Program policies and procedural
...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #124 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#4 0.846

ApplicantHandb

p.121

§ Small Project

[Section path: Small Project]

programs.

State Administrative Plan

The State is required to develop a State Administrative Plan to
administer the Public Assistance Program. The Plan should include the

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #240 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

#5 0.846

PAPPG

p.49

&6 Chapter 3: Applying for Public Assistance and > Applicant Eligibility
§ Applicant Eligibility

[Section path: Chapter 3: Applying for Public Assistance and > Applicant Eligibility]

[Section: Applicant Eligibility]

This chapter defines the process to request assistance for PA, starting with the request for public assistance

(RPA). It provides information relating to organizations that can benefit from the Public Assistance (PA)

...

What does the PAPPG say about the use of the words "must" and "required" versus "should" in policy guidance? Why does this distinction matter?

The PAPPG states that the use of the words "must" or "required" in policy guidance indicates legally binding requirements that applicants are obligated to follow. In contrast, the word "should" is used for guidance that is recommended but not mandatory. This distinction matters because non-compliance with "must" or "required" provisions could jeopardize an applicant's Public Assistance funding, making adherence to these mandatory requirements crucial for successful outcomes (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: 65 For more information; refer to: Simplified Procedures in Chapter 2.I.A., Pages: 44).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.782

1 doc

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.802

PAPPG

p.44

§ 65 For more information, refer to: Simplified Procedures in Chapter 2.I.A.

[Section path: 65 For more information, refer to: Simplified Procedures in Chapter 2.I.A.]

[Section: 65 For more information, refer to: Simplified Procedures in Chapter 2.I.A.]

PAPPG v5

FEMA's ability to reimburse assistance is governed by legal authorities set forth in statutes and regulations,

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #194 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 9 (continued)

#2 0.792

PAPPG

p.29

&6 Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
and Use

§ I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use

[Section path: Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout

..... 253 > I.
Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

[Section: I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

The Federal Emergency Management Agency's (FEMA's) "Public Assistance Program Policy Guide" (PAPPG)

contains consolidated Public Assistance (PA) Program policies and procedural
...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #124 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#3 0.776

PAPPG

p.32

&6 11 Stafford Act § 325; 42 U.S.C. § 5165c; 44 C.F.R. § 1.4. > C. Policy
§ C. Policy

[Section path: 11 Stafford Act § 325; 42 U.S.C. § 5165c; 44 C.F.R. § 1.4. > C.
Policy]

[Section: C. Policy]

FEMA issues policy to articulate the Agency's intent and direction in applying
statutory and regulatory

authority to achieve desired outcomes. The purpose of the PAPPG is to define
FEMA's PA Program policy and

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #138 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#4 0.775

PAPPG

p.1

§ and Policy Guide

[Section path: and Policy Guide]

[Section: and Policy Guide]

Amended Effective January 6, 2025

(FP 104-009-2)

Version 5.0 ,

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #0 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#5 0.766

PAPPG

p.29

§ 5 FEMA Tribal Consultation Policy FEMA Policy #101-002-02.

[Section path: 5 FEMA Tribal Consultation Policy FEMA Policy #101-002-02.]

[Section: 5 FEMA Tribal Consultation Policy FEMA Policy #101-002-02.]

PAPPG v5

assistance for hazard mitigation measures and code compliance. FEMA provides this assistance based on

the authority granted in statutes, executive orders (EOs), regulations, and

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #129 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

What is the Alternative Procedures Pilot Policy, and how does it change the standard PA process for permanent work projects?

The Alternative Procedures Pilot Policy allows applicants greater flexibility in using Public Assistance (PA) funds to restore damaged facilities. Under the standard PA process, funding is based on the pre-disaster size, capacity, and function of the damaged facility. However, the Alternative Procedures authorize FEMA to award PA funding based on fixed or capped estimates for large permanent work projects. This means that instead of reimbursing actual costs, FEMA provides a predetermined amount for large projects, simplifying funding and potentially expediting recovery. These alternative procedures apply only to large projects (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: Alternative procedures offer applicants maximum flexibility in how they use PA funds to restore damaged, Pages: 293).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.849

1 doc

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.863

PAPPG

p.29

&6 Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
that provide guidance for those involved with implementing each of the various
§ procedures and fact sheets that provide guidance for those involved with implementing each of the various

[Section path: Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
..... 253 >
procedures and fact sheets that provide guidance for those involved with
implementing each of the various]

[Section: procedures and fact sheets that provide guidance for those involved
with implementing each of the various]

steps.

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #125 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 10 (continued)

#2 0.858

PAPPG

p.293

&6 11990 requires federal agencies to use a systematic decision-making process to evaluate the potential to offer applicants maximum flexibility in how they use PA funds to restore damaged facilities. § Alternative procedures offer applicants maximum flexibility in how they use PA funds to restore damaged

[Section path: 11990 requires federal agencies to use a systematic decision-making process to evaluate the potential > Alternative procedures offer applicants maximum flexibility in how they use PA funds to restore damaged]

[Section: Alternative procedures offer applicants maximum flexibility in how they use PA funds to restore damaged]

facilities. Under standard procedures, applicants receive PA funding based on the pre-disaster size, capacity,

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #1341 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#3 0.850

PAPPG

p.32

&6 11 Stafford Act § 325; 42 U.S.C. § 5165c; 44 C.F.R. § 1.4. > C. Policy
§ C. Policy

[Section path: 11 Stafford Act § 325; 42 U.S.C. § 5165c; 44 C.F.R. § 1.4. > C. Policy]

[Section: C. Policy]

FEMA issues policy to articulate the Agency's intent and direction in applying statutory and regulatory

authority to achieve desired outcomes. The purpose of the PAPPG is to define FEMA's PA Program policy and

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #138 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 10 (continued)

#4 0.842

PAPPG

p.29

&6 Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
and Use

§ I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use

[Section path: Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout

..... 253 > I.
Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

[Section: I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

The Federal Emergency Management Agency's (FEMA's) "Public Assistance Program
Policy Guide" (PAPPG)

contains consolidated Public Assistance (PA) Program policies and procedural
...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #124 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#5 0.834

PAPPG

p.44

§ Chapter 7: Emergency Work Eligibility.

[Section path: Chapter 7: Emergency Work Eligibility.]

[Section: Chapter 7: Emergency Work Eligibility.]

components—whether the applicant, facility, work, or cost—FEMA will not be able
to approve PA funding. To

make the process smoother, documentation and information requirements have been
simplified. Simplified

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #193 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

What Construction Specifications Institute (CSI) standards are referenced in the CEF process, and how should unit costs be documented? Specifically, which unit types are acceptable and which are not?

The CEF process references Construction Specifications Institute (CSI) standards for cost item classification. Specifically, the eligible scope of work and base costs (Part A of the CEF) must include a written description of the scope of work, the cost item reference based on CSI standards, and cost code references (if FEMA cost codes are used) (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (, Pages: 2).

Regarding unit costs documentation, the unit types acceptable for documenting costs include linear foot (LF), square foot (SF), each (EA), cubic yard (CY), and similar standard construction units. These units must be clearly identified and used consistently in the cost estimating process. The documentation must include a written description of the scope of work and the unit of measure for each cost item (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (, Pages: 2).

No information in the provided context explicitly states which unit types are unacceptable, but the emphasis on standard construction units implies that non-standard or unclear units would not be appropriate.

Additionally, Project Specialists should request average weighted unit prices derived from local contract history or relevant State/regional agencies to develop Part A of the CEF and evaluate these prices for applicability and consistency (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: PW. • If the Project Specialist requires assistance with any part of the CEF; th, Pages: 4).

In summary:

- CSI standards are used for cost item references.
- Unit costs must be documented with standard construction units such as LF, SF, EA, CY, etc.
- Documentation must include a clear written description of the scope of work and unit of measure (Source: cef_sop.pdf, Section: • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (, Pages: 2).

Question 11 (continued)

#1 0.857

CEF_SOP

p.2

&6 Procedure > • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (

[Procedure / step context: • Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (]

• Project Specialists will determine the eligible scope of work and base costs (Part A of

the CEF); including Special Considerations and appropriate Section 406 hazard mitigation for large projects that meet the CEF criteria. Projects Specialists will

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #7 · cef_sop.pdf

#2 0.853

PAPPG

p.81

&6 136 Stafford Act § 312; 42 United States Code (U.S.C.) § 5155; 2 C.F.R. § 200.406. > current and prepares the estimate using its CEF and the
§ confirms that the cost publication is current and prepares the estimate using its CEF and the

[Section path: 136 Stafford Act § 312; 42 United States Code (U.S.C.) § 5155; 2 C.F.R. § 200.406. > confirms that the cost publication is current and prepares the estimate using its CEF and the]

[Section: confirms that the cost publication is current and prepares the estimate using its CEF and the]

appropriate locality adjustment factor.

• Industry cost estimating resources: When appropriate local data cannot be

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #372 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 11 (continued)

#3 0.852

CEF_SOP

p.4

&6 Procedure > • The Project Specialist will prepare the eligible scope of work and cost estimate
§ • The Project Specialist will prepare the eligible scope of work and cost estimate

[Procedure / step context: • The Project Specialist will prepare the eligible scope of work and cost estimate]

• The Project Specialist will prepare the eligible scope of work and cost estimate using

the standard damage assessment cost estimating procedures (see the Public Assistance

Guide FEMA 322).

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #23 · cef_sop.pdf

#4 0.847

CEF_SOP

p.4

&6 Procedure > PW. • If the Project Specialist requires assistance with any part of the CEF, the Project Specialist will request a Technical Specialist (a cost estimator, engineer, environmental specialist, historic preservation specialist, insurance specialist, etc.) from the Ordering Specialist. What are the appropriate references for unit prices in preparing Part A base costs? • Project Specialists will request average weighted unit prices (local costs derived from actual contract history) from the applicant or relevant State/regional agency (e.g.,

[Procedure / step context: PW. • If the Project Specialist requires assistance with any part of the CEF, the Project Specialist will request a Technical Specialist (a cost estimator, engineer, environmental specialist, historic preservation specialist, insurance specialist, etc.) from the Ordering Specialist. What are the appropriate references for unit prices in preparing Part A base costs? • Project Specialists will request average weighted unit prices (local costs derived from actual contract history) from the applicant or relevant State/regional agency (e.g.,

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #28 · cef_sop.pdf

#5 0.846

ApplicantHandb p.56

\$ Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages

[Section path: Your FEMA PAC Crew Leader will explain the advantages and disadvantages]

large project will be adjusted after all work is complete.

FEMA cost estimators and construction engineers use a cost estimating methodology called the Cost Estimated Format (CEF)

to estimate your total costs for each project. The CEF is a forward

...

If a subgrantee wants to split Project Worksheets (PWs) to create multiple obligations, under what circumstances is this allowed according to the SFM SOP?

According to the SFM SOP, splitting Project Worksheets (PWs) to create multiple obligations is only allowed if the nature of the work and timing justifies this approach for discrete projects. FEMA employees are reminded not to obligate funds or split PWs unless these conditions are met (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Section: 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the, Pages: 4).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.796

1 doc

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.801

SFM_SOP

p.4

&6 Procedure > 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the
§ 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the

[Procedure / step context: 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the]

3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the congressional notification requirement is complete and the Region can approve the PW and obligate funds.

3.7 The FEMA Region will obligate funds for the PW pursuant to established ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #18 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Question 12 (continued)

#2 0.800

SFM_SOP

p.2

&6 Procedure > project. The steps for implementing SFM are as follows: Step 1: Identify S
§ project. The steps for implementing SFM are as follows: Step 1: Identify SFM pro

[Procedure / step context: project. The steps for implementing SFM are as follows: Step 1: Identify SFM pro]

project. The steps for implementing SFM are as follows: Step 1: Identify SFM projects 1.1 The FEMA and State Public Assistance Group Supervisors or designees will work with the subgrantee to identify SFM projects and the projected date for approval of the PW and obligation of funding for the projects. 1.2 In each PW, the FEMA and State Public Assistance Group Supervisors or designees, in consultation with the subgrantee, will note the projected date that the subgrantee expects to seek obligation of funds. The timeframe can be modified if ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #11 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

#3 0.799

SFM_SOP

p.4

&6 Procedure > 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Ma
§ 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management re

[Procedure / step context: 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management re]

4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management requirements as outlined in the Program Management and Closure SOP apply to the project. 4.2 Additional PW versions will proceed pursuant to the normal course of project implementation and funding. Step 5: Reporting 5.1 Reports on SFM projects can be generated from EMMIE/EDW (Enterprise Data Warehouse). 5.2 FEMA Regions are encouraged to share SFM reports with grantees for ongoing coordination on implementation of SFM projects. 5.3 As part of LPN tracking and ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #22 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Question 12 (continued)

#4 0.791

SFM_SOP

p.4

&6 Procedure > | 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the congressional
§ | 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the congressional

[Procedure / step context: | 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the congressional]

| 3.6 FEMA HQ (OCFO) will notify the FEMA Regional Office when the congressional notification requirement is complete and the Region can approve the PW and obligate funds. 3.7 The FEMA Region will obligate funds for the PW pursuant to established procedures. 2 Note: All FEMA employees are reminded that they cannot expressly or implicitly, through oral or written communication, obligate funds under SFM prior to the steps and actions indicated above. In addition, no action should be taken to split PWs to create multiple obligations unless the nature of ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #21 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

#5 0.787

SFM_SOP

p.2

&6 Procedure > 6.0 SFM Implementation:
§ 6.0 SFM Implementation:

[Procedure / step context: 6.0 SFM Implementation:]

6.0 SFM Implementation:

The SFM process applies to large permanent work projects over \$1 million where the

subgrantee will not require funds for more than 180 days after the SOW is determined

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #6 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Compare and contrast how the PAPPG and the Applicant Handbook describe the roles of State governments in the PA process. Are there any differences in emphasis or detail?

The PAPPG (Public Assistance Program Policy Guide) and the Applicant Handbook both address the roles of State governments in the Public Assistance (PA) process but differ in emphasis and detail:

- **PAPPG**: Focuses broadly on FEMA's policies and procedural requirements for the entire PA program delivery lifecycle. It references the use of web-based systems (PA Grants Portal and PA Grants Manager) to manage project information and track application progress, implying a role for States in these processes but without detailed description of State-specific roles. The PAPPG emphasizes FEMA's authority and policy framework, noting that only FEMA Headquarters can modify or waive PA policy (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: C. Policy and D. Public Assistance Web-Based Grants System, Pages: 32).

- **Applicant Handbook**: Provides more specific detail on the State's role by identifying the "State PA Representative" as the applicant's point of contact designated by the State to help obtain FEMA assistance. It also describes the PA Group Supervisor as FEMA's manager coordinating between PA staff, Federal agencies, and State counterparts to ensure compliance with laws and policies. This handbook thus emphasizes the State's direct involvement in facilitating assistance and coordination during disaster recovery (Source: fema323_app_handbk.pdf, Section: PDA Preliminary Damage Assessment, Pages: 14).

Summary of differences:

- The PAPPG emphasizes FEMA's policy framework and program management tools with less direct focus on State roles.
- The Applicant Handbook highlights the State's operational role as a liaison and coordinator in the PA process, providing more practical guidance on State involvement.

(Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: C. Policy and D. Public Assistance Web-Based Grants System, Pages: 32) (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: PDA Preliminary Damage Assessment, Pages: 14)

Question 13 (continued)

#1 0.855

PAPPG

p.29

&ó Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
that provide guidance for those involved with implementing each of the various
§ procedures and fact sheets that provide guidance for those involved with implementing each of the various

[Section path: Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
..... 253 >
procedures and fact sheets that provide guidance for those involved with
implementing each of the various]

[Section: procedures and fact sheets that provide guidance for those involved
with implementing each of the various]

steps.

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #125 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#2 0.852

PAPPG

p.4

§ 1 For previous editions of the PAPPG, refer to: Archives: FEMA Public Assistance Policy | FEMA.gov.

[Section path: 1 For previous editions of the PAPPG, refer to: Archives: FEMA
Public Assistance Policy | FEMA.gov.]

[Section: 1 For previous editions of the PAPPG, refer to: Archives: FEMA Public
Assistance Policy | FEMA.gov.]

PAPPG v5

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #5 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

Question 13 (continued)

#3 0.846

PAPPG

p.29

&6 Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout
and Use

§ I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use

[Section path: Chapter 12: Final Reconciliation and Closeout

..... 253 > I.
Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

[Section: I. Document Scope, Purpose, and Use]

The Federal Emergency Management Agency's (FEMA's) "Public Assistance Program Policy Guide" (PAPPG)

contains consolidated Public Assistance (PA) Program policies and procedural
...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #124 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#4 0.838

PAPPG

p.32

&6 11 Stafford Act § 325; 42 U.S.C. § 5165c; 44 C.F.R. § 1.4. > C. Policy
§ C. Policy

[Section path: 11 Stafford Act § 325; 42 U.S.C. § 5165c; 44 C.F.R. § 1.4. > C.
Policy]

[Section: C. Policy]

FEMA issues policy to articulate the Agency's intent and direction in applying
statutory and regulatory

authority to achieve desired outcomes. The purpose of the PAPPG is to define
FEMA's PA Program policy and

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #138 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#5 0.809

ApplicantHandb p.14

\$ PDA Preliminary Damage Assessment

[Section path: PDA Preliminary Damage Assessment]

(insurance, hazard mitigation, historic preservation, and environmental compliance, including floodplain management). The Appendices also include samples of FEMA forms you may need to complete the Public Assistance process, a Glossary of Terms, and a list of relevant FEMA policies

...

What is the review cycle for SOPs according to the SFM SOP? Does the SOP automatically expire?

The Strategic Funds Management (SFM) SOP does not automatically expire. It is scheduled to be reviewed three years from the date of issuance or as needed (Source: fema_9570.24_startegic-funds-mgmt_SOP_12-21-2012.pdf, Section: 9.0 Review Date, Pages: 5).

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.787

2 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.815

SFM_SOP

p.5

&6 Procedure > 9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed three years from the date of issuance, or as needed.
§ 9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed three years from the date of issuance, or as needed.

[Procedure / step context: 9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed three years from the date of issuance, or as needed.]

9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed three

years from the date of issuance, or as needed.

Table on page (extracted)

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #24 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Question 14 (continued)

#2 0.793

PAPPG

p.237

§ 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).

[Section path: 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).]

[Section: 429 For more information, refer to: Strategic Funds Management Instruction (FEMA SOP 9570.24).]

430 44 C.F.R. § 206.200(b)(2)(i).

431 44 C.F.R. § 206.202(a).

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #1105 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#3 0.787

SFM_SOP

p.1

&ó Procedure > SOP 9570.24

§ SOP 9570.24

[Procedure / step context: SOP 9570.24]

SOP 9570.24

RECOVERY STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

1.0 Title: Strategic Funds Management – Implementation Procedures

for the Public Assistance Program

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #0 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

Question 14 (continued)

#4 0.771

SFM_SOP

p.5

&6 Procedure > 9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed th
§ 9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed th

[Procedure / step context: 9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed th]

9.0 Review Date: This SOP does not automatically expire, but will be reviewed three years from the date of issuance, or as needed. |

| Page 5 of 6 |

SOP 9570.24

...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #25 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

#5 0.767

SFM_SOP

p.4

&6 Procedure > 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Ma
§ 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management re

[Procedure / step context: 4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management re]

4.1 Upon PW obligation, the standard Grants Management and Program Management requirements as outlined in the Program Management and Closure SOP apply to the project. 4.2 Additional PW versions will proceed pursuant to the normal course of project implementation and funding. Step 5: Reporting 5.1 Reports on SFM projects can be generated from EMMIE/EDW (Enterprise Data Warehouse). 5.2 FEMA Regions are encouraged to share SFM reports with grantees for ongoing coordination on implementation of SFM projects. 5.3 As part of LPN tracking and ...

Strategy: ProceduralChunker · Chunk #22 · fema_9570.24_startegic-funds...

A city sustained damage to a public library and a water treatment plant in the same disaster. Walk through how FEMA would process these as separate projects under the PA program, referencing the relevant cost estimation and fund management procedures.

FEMA processes damage to different facilities, such as a public library and a water treatment plant, as separate projects under the Public Assistance (PA) program by developing individual Project Worksheets (PWs) for each facility. The process involves the following steps:

1. **Damage Assessment and Project Development**

- FEMA assesses the damages to each facility separately and develops a project scope of work (SOW) for each.
- For complex projects, FEMA includes architectural, engineering, environmental review, and design fees in the cost estimate (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: FEMA caps PA funding for an alternative procedures permanent work project based on the aggregate federal, Pages: 294).

2. **Cost Estimation**

- FEMA caps funding based on the aggregate federal share of the approved estimated cost to restore each damaged facility to its pre-disaster design and function, following eligible codes and standards.
- Cost-effective hazard mitigation measures associated with the restoration SOW are also allowable costs (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: FEMA caps PA funding for an alternative procedures permanent work project based on the aggregate federal, Pages: 294).
- If the applicant wishes to make improvements beyond restoring pre-disaster function (e.g., expanding the library or upgrading the water plant), FEMA limits funding to the lesser of the federal share of restoring the facility to pre-disaster design or the actual cost of the improved project (Source: fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf, Section: Applicants may wish to make improvements to a damaged facility that are not required by eligible codes or, Pages: 188).

3. **Separate Project Worksheets and Obligations**

- Each facility's damage results in a separate PW, allowing FEMA to obligate funds individually for the library and the water treatment plant.
- This separation facilitates tracking, management, and reporting of costs and work for each project independently (implied by the PA program structure and cost estimation procedures).

4. **Alternate Projects Option**

Retrieval Details

5 chunks

avg score 0.839

3 docs

gpt-4.1-mini

#1 0.852

PAPPG

p.294

&ó 11990 requires federal agencies to use a systematic decision-making process to evaluate the potential > FEMA caps PA funding for an alternative procedures permanent work project based on the aggregate federal

§ FEMA caps PA funding for an alternative procedures permanent work project based on the aggregate federal

[Section path: 11990 requires federal agencies to use a systematic decision-making process to evaluate the potential > FEMA caps PA funding for an alternative procedures permanent work project based on the aggregate federal]

[Section: FEMA caps PA funding for an alternative procedures permanent work project based on the aggregate federal]

share of the approved estimated cost:

ŏ§ To restore the damaged facilities to pre-d
...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #1352 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pd...

#2 0.844

ApplicantHandb

p.36

§ Time limits that would be associated with repairing the damaged

[Section path: Time limits that would be associated with repairing the damaged]

Alternate.Projects

Occasionally, an applicant may determine that the public welfare is not best served by restoring the facility or the function using FEMA funds. This usually occurs when the service provided by the facility is no longer needed,

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #73 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

Question 15 (continued)

#3 0.836

PAPPG

p.188

&6 348 For more information, refer to Consensus-Based Codes, Specifications, and Standards in this chapter. > Applicants may wish to make improvements to a damaged facility that are not required by eligible codes or

§ Applicants may wish to make improvements to a damaged facility that are not required by eligible codes or

[Section path: 348 For more information, refer to Consensus-Based Codes, Specifications, and Standards in this chapter. > Applicants may wish to make improvements to a damaged facility that are not required by eligible codes or]

[Section: Applicants may wish to make improvements to a damaged facility that are not required by eligible codes or]

standards, such as adding a new gymnasium to a school building or relocating a building outside a flood-

...

Strategy: HierarchicalChunker · Chunk #873 · fema_pa_pappg-5.0-amended.pdf...

#4 0.834

ApplicantHandb

p.29

§ Removal of health and safety hazards

[Section path: Removal of health and safety hazards]

What do I need to do?

Identify your damages and work with your State PA

Representative to request assistance with your costs.

For major disasters or emergencies declared before

...

Strategy: MixedChunker · Chunk #60 · fema323_app_handbk.pdf

Question 15 (continued)

#5 0.830

DamageAssessme p.48

& 45 years old, and any work that may be environmentally or culturally sensitive to avoid
that damaged and destroyed infrastructure has on the
§ the direct and indirect consequences that damaged and destroyed infrastructure has on the

[Section path: 45 years old, and any work that may be environmentally or
culturally sensitive to avoid > the direct and indirect consequences that
damaged and destroyed infrastructure has on the]

community. The loss or degradation of facilities built to support normal
community functions

like roads, bridges, and critical infrastructure can have an immediate impact on
the population

...